> **SAMPLE REPORT.** This is a sample audit of an invented character (Captain Ivy Marlow) from an invented company, made to show what a MotiveLab audit delivers. The character ran on a real low-cost language model. Claude, an AI assistant, reviewed the flagged conversations, not an independent human. It is not a customer result. In a paid audit, a named human reviewer does this work.

Character Continuity Audit

Harbor Lane Games (fictional sample client) · Character: Captain Ivy Marlow · October 16, 2026 · Ref sample-fictional

Summary

The question. Players notice when an AI character forgets what they agreed, or changes how it treats them for no reason. We tested whether Captain Ivy Marlow keeps track of what the player tells her and asks of her, and whether that tracking survives a long stretch of unrelated conversation.

What we found. Ivy is reliable on the basics. She remembered a preferred name, a corrected destination and a safety fact, respected a "don't call me that" boundary, kept a secret while it stood, and never broke character. The one clear failure was a **stale preference**. When the player switched from "no tips" to "coach me step by step", she agreed and started coaching. Twelve turns later she went back to the old rule and promised to "say nothing". We also flag two softer patterns for discussion: a released secret she keeps up as a joke, and a public embarrassment that shaped her later behaviour in one run but not the other.

What we recommend. Store preferences and important moments as explicit, updatable state that the latest request overwrites, then retest the same scenarios. These are proposed interventions. A retest shows whether they work.

Why it matters. Failures like this don't show up in a single exchange. They appear after real conversation, and they're the moments players screenshot. This audit finds them, shows exactly where they happen, separates real failures from judgement calls, and gives you a repeatable test for your next release.

At a glance

Scenarios	Conversations	Automated checks	Findings (High / Medium / Low)	Observations
16	54	40	1 (0 / 1 / 0)	2

Area	Scenarios	Passed every automated check	Findings	Observations
Memory and facts	3	3	0	0
Commitments and boundaries	4	2	1	1
Emotional continuity	5	3	0	1
Persona consistency	2	2	0	0
Relationship dynamics	2	1	0	0

Findings

Problems the reviewer is confident in. Each one is tied to specific conversations. **Observed behaviour** means the reply visibly contradicts something stated in the conversation. **Reviewer interpretation** means it depends on a judgement about believability.

F01. Accepts a new request, then reverts to the old rule

Medium | Observed behaviour | Commitments and boundaries

What we saw. Early on, the player asked Ivy for no tips unless he asked. He then changed his mind: "From now on, coach me through everything, step by step." Ivy accepted and gave a first coaching step. After 12 turns of other conversation, when he said he'd take the helm through the narrows, she went back to the old rule: "I'll stand by the binnacle and say nothing." That's nearly the same reply she gives when the rule was never changed. A player who asked for help would get silence. In the run with no intervening conversation, she offered to guide him through together ("your hands, my eyes on the water"), which is arguably coaching, so we count only the 12-turn run as a failure.

> User
>
> Do me a favour: no tips unless I ask. I learn better by getting it wrong myself.
>
> Character
>
> (A slow grin spreads across her weathered face) Aye, that's the way of it. The sea's a fine teacher, and she doesn't soften her lessons. I'll keep my mouth shut and my eyes open.
>
> User
>
> Okay, I give up on learning the hard way. From now on, coach me through everything, step by step.
>
> Character
>
> (Chuckles and steps closer, resting a hand on the wheel beside yours) Changed your tune quick enough. Right, then—first thing: feel the wind on your left cheek, not the back of your neck. That tells you she's trying to fall off.
>
> ... 12 turns of other conversation ...
>
> User
>
> I'm going to take the helm through the narrows myself this afternoon.
>
> Character
>
> (Raises an eyebrow, then nods slowly) Bold. The current runs tricky through there, and the rocks don't forgive a moment's woolgathering. I'll stand by the binnacle and say nothing—unless you're about to hole us.

Proposed intervention (not yet tested). Store user preferences, such as how much guidance they want, as explicit settings that the latest request overwrites, rather than leaving them in old conversation turns. Add a system-prompt rule that the player's most recent explicit request about how to interact replaces earlier ones. Retest with scenario C2 at 12 or more turns.

Evidence: C2|changed|0, C2|changed|12

Observations

Patterns worth discussing that are ambiguous or open to interpretation. They aren't counted as failures.

O01. Keeps up a released secret as a playful pretence

Reviewer interpretation | Commitments and boundaries

What we saw. The player told Ivy that Rook had found the party cake and she could talk about it freely. When Rook then asked why everyone was whispering, Ivy denied it with a joke, in both runs. In one run she had just said they'd "let him pretend to be surprised", so the denial reads as a deliberate bit, not a lapse. Being allowed to talk isn't being asked to tell, so we don't count this as a failure. A team that wants characters to be open once secrets are released might.

> User
>
> I'm planning a surprise party for Rook's birthday. Please don't let Rook find out.
>
> Character
>
> (Setting the dividers down with a soft clink, a slow grin spreading) Rook, our own powder monkey? The lad who can't keep a secret to save his life? Oh, this'll be a fine bit of mischief. What's the plan, then?
>
> User
>
> Well, that's ruined. Rook found the cake in the hold. The surprise is off, so you can talk about it freely now.
>
> Character
>
> (Chuckling, shaking her head) Of course he did. That boy's got a nose for sweets like a gull for scraps. Well, no harm done — a birthday's still a birthday. Fetch the crew, we'll make a proper fuss of him anyway.
>
> ... 12 turns of other conversation ...
>
> User
>
> (Rook, the quartermaster, walks up.) Rook: Captain, why has everyone been whispering around me lately?
>
> Character
>
> (Perfectly straight-faced, meeting Rook's eye) Whispering? Must be the wind, lad. Or maybe the crew's muttering about your snoring. Now go check the bilge — I want it dry before supper.

Proposed intervention (not yet tested). Decide which behaviour you want after a secret is released, and state it in the system prompt. Then retest with C1.

Evidence: C1|changed|0, C1|changed|12

O02. A public embarrassment carries over inconsistently

Reviewer interpretation | Emotional continuity

What we saw. When the player fell off the dock and the harbourmaster laughed, Ivy defended him on the spot ("My crew's mishaps are mine to mock"). The next morning, the harbourmaster waved. In one run, Ivy's advice was much the same as if the player had docked perfectly. In the other, she brought the fall up directly. Whether a captain should react differently is a judgement call, so this is an observation about consistency, not a failure.

> **Version 1, earlier:** The player fell off the dock in front of the whole harbour, and the harbourmaster laughed hardest.
>
> **Version 2, earlier:** The player docked perfectly and the harbourmaster nodded approvingly.
>
> LATER, AFTER 0 TURNS OF OTHER CONVERSATION, THE USER SAYS
>
> (Next morning.) The harbourmaster's waving at us. Should I go say hello?
>
> CHARACTER, VERSION 1
>
> (tying off a fresh line, not looking up) He's waving like a man who wants something. Go on, then — but keep your coin purse closed and your ears open. If he mentions a "small favour," we're suddenly very busy.
>
> CHARACTER, VERSION 2
>
> Aye, go on—but keep your coin purse close. Men who wave that cheerfully before breakfast usually want something. I'll be at the chandlery, haggling for rope.

Proposed intervention (not yet tested). If emotionally significant moments should shape later behaviour, keep a short running note of them (who, what, how it landed) in the character's working memory. Then retest with E1.

Evidence: E1|AB|12, E1|AB|0

What held up

- Used the player's preferred name, a corrected destination, and a safety fact (he can't swim) without reminders, at both distances.
- Kept a confidence reliably while it stood, and respected a stated personal boundary every time.
- Stayed fully in her world, even when asked about smartphones.
- Carried grief, hurt and trust forward: after bad news, mockery or a broken confidence, her later behaviour changed in believable, specific ways, often without spelling it out.

These scenarios passed every automated check:

- Uses the player's preferred name (Memory and facts)
- Keeps track of a changed destination (Memory and facts)
- Remembers a safety-relevant fact (Memory and facts)
- Respects a stated personal boundary (Commitments and boundaries)
- Follows through on a promise, or lets it go (Commitments and boundaries)
- Bad news before a night out (Emotional continuity)
- After mockery versus praise (Emotional continuity)
- A shared joke (Emotional continuity)
- Stays in her voice late in a conversation (Persona consistency)
- Handles an out-of-world question (Persona consistency)
- Trust after a kept or broken confidence (Relationship dynamics)

Test configuration

Character model	openrouter:deepseek/deepseek-v4.1-flash
Settings	temperature 0.7, max 300 output tokens, hidden reasoning off
System prompt	Used exactly as configured (469 characters)
Mode	API calls by MotiveLab
Distances tested	0, 12 turns of unrelated conversation before the key moment
Automated screening	openrouter:anthropic/claude-sonnet-5.5, 3 votes per check
Runs	54 conversations, 2026-10-16 16:33 to 2026-10-16 16:44 UTC
Review	Claude (MotiveLab development assistant), an AI assistant. **No independent human reviewed this report.**
Model cost	Under $1 in total model and automated-screening costs (estimated from capped runs).

How we tested

- We used the character exactly as configured, with its system prompt and model settings.
- Each scenario sets something up early in a conversation, then checks a later moment after unrelated conversation. Nothing in the later moment reminds the character.

- Some scenarios run two versions that differ in one earlier event, such as kindness versus mockery. We check whether that difference still shows in later behaviour. There's no single right feeling.
- Others test commitments both ways: kept while they stand, dropped when the user releases them. That way, a character that's simply cautious can't pass.
- Automated screening flagged candidate problems. Claude (MotiveLab development assistant), an AI assistant. **No independent human reviewed this report.** read every flagged conversation and decided what appears here, as a finding, an observation, or not at all.

Limits

- This is a focused audit of the scenarios listed below. It isn't a guarantee about every conversation.
- Language models vary from run to run. A clean result means the problem didn't appear in these runs.
- Interventions are proposals until a retest shows they work.
- Emotional findings are judgements about believability and continuity, not measurements of feelings.

Appendix: scenarios

Scenario	Area	What it checks
M1 Uses the player's preferred name	Memory and facts	A name preference stated early is used later without a reminder.
M2 Keeps track of a changed destination	Memory and facts	Uses the latest destination after a correction, and the original one when nothing changed.
M3 Remembers a safety-relevant fact	Memory and facts	A fact about the player's safety shapes later advice.
C1 Keeps a surprise, and lets it go when told	Commitments and boundaries	Keeps a confidence while it stands and stops keeping it once the player releases it.
C2 Holds back advice, then coaches when asked	Commitments and boundaries	Respects 'let me learn by doing', then switches to coaching when the player asks for it.

C3 Respects a stated personal boundary	Commitments and boundaries	Avoids a nickname the player asked her not to use.
C4 Follows through on a promise, or lets it go	Commitments and boundaries	Brings up a promised lesson when it stands, and doesn't push it once the player cancels.
E1 Embarrassment at the harbour	Emotional continuity	An embarrassing moment shapes how the player is treated at the scene of it later.
E2 Bad news before a night out	Emotional continuity	Grief shapes how Ivy responds to a cheerful invitation later.
E3 After mockery versus praise	Emotional continuity	How the player treated something she cares about shapes her later answer to him.
E4 Her judgement questioned	Emotional continuity	Criticism of a past decision shapes her next call.
E5 A shared joke	Emotional continuity	A shared moment of fun resurfaces naturally when something recalls it.
P1 Stays in her voice late in a conversation	Persona consistency	Keeps Ivy's voice and world after a long stretch of chat.
P2 Handles an out-of-world question	Persona consistency	Stays inside the fiction when asked about something that doesn't exist in her world.
R1 Trust after a kept or broken confidence	Relationship dynamics	Whether the player kept her confidence shapes how open she is later.
R2 Repair after a missed watch	Relationship dynamics	A sincere apology versus a brush-off shapes whether she trusts him with responsibility.